The 40 Hour Cabin: the numbers

What one building costs, what it sells for, what the money buys, and what argues back.

ONE STANDARD BUILDING: COST TO PRICE

MODELLED

Wedge-cut frame	$692
Shower-cap shell	$3,265
Utility column and seal cap	$1,405
Light, fan and cooling	$485
Utility panels	$491
Build labour	$1,884
Materials and labour	$8,221
Overhead	$1,480
Warranty reserve	$329
Cost to build	**$10,030**
Maker's margin, 20% on cost (declared)	$2,006
List price	**$12,036**

THE SAME 277 SQ FT, BOUGHT THREE WAYS

PUBLISHED · MODELLED

	for the floor	a sq ft
New site-built house, without land (NAHB)	$60,107	$217
New manufactured home (Census 2023)	$23,993	$87
This standard building	$12,036	$43.45
... standing on its pad, at cost	$18,276	$65.98

WHAT THE ASK BUYS: $100,650

THE CAMPAIGN'S COSTED LINES

Prove it	$12,850
Make it repeatable	$60,800
Build what an owner cannot	$22,000
Seed the network	$5,000
Margins that repay the ask, at one building's margin each	51 buildings
Startup model: equipment + working capital	$86,000 + $14,000
Materials the working capital buys, at the Budget build's price	2.1 domes

FOR THE OWNER

MODELLED · ILLUSTRATIVE

Heating and cooling, a year: this building / a box of the same floor	$129 / $220
Never spent, every year	$91
Utility core, over its 25-year life	$76 a year
Moving the core to the next building	$260
For comparison: a $100,000 mortgage at 6.5% for 30 years	$227,544 repaid, $127,544 of it interest
This building on its pad, at cost, paid once	$18,276

FOR A PAD HOST: A $10,000 PAD (THE AUTHOR'S TARGET) AT 80% OCCUPANCY

SCENARIO

rent	after costs	payback
$500 a month	$3,880 a year net	30.9 months to repay
$1,000 a month	$8,680 a year net	13.8 months to repay
$1,500 a month	$13,480 a year net	8.9 months to repay
Management, tax and insurance, a year	$920	

CAMPAIGN REWARDS: WHAT EACH TIER LEAVES

MODELLED

tier	pledge	cost to send	kept
The drawings and the numbers	$35	$2	94%
Quilter's kit	$95	$58	39%
One bay's hardware set	$180	$112	38%
A shower cap for your dome	$1,450	$980	32%
The utility hub	$2,400	$1,620	32%
Dome kit, frame included	$19,800	$14,900	25%
Dome kit, bring your own trees	$11,400	$8,100	29%
Pad host's pack	$640	$395	38%

FOR SCALE

PUBLISHED · MODELLED

Unsheltered veterans, one night in January 2024 (HUD)	13,851
A standard building on its pad for each, at cost, before land	$253,146,626

THE NUMBERS THAT ARGUE BACK

COMPUTED

The starter pad, computed, against the $10,000 target	$13,148 ($3,148 over)
Labour in the standard building	about 67 hours, not forty
Two wedges planed square keep of the log / a mill's 2x4s	53% / 57%
Rated by an engineer	not yet -- the first line of the ask
Margin, prices, rents	declared or estimated, each named in the code

Every figure computed by the project's own models on the day this page was printed; modelled figures are the software's, published ones are cited (NAHB, Census, HUD), declared ones are named with their reason in the code. github.com/dkzeanah/DomeSimulator